

Tusla Policy Submission Pack

CHILDREN FIRST ACT 2015 — SECTION 36 & SECTION 5 PLACEMENTS

1 SERVICE NAME & PURPOSE

Service: Chosanta Management — providing safe, trauma-informed residential care and emergency accommodation to children under the care of Tusla, including placements under Section 36 and Section 5.

2 CHILD PROTECTION POLICY

We are committed to safeguarding all children. Every child has the right to live free from abuse, exploitation, and neglect. Applies to all staff, volunteers, contractors, and any person working on behalf of the organisation.

Definitions:

- ✓ **Child:** Person under 18 · **DLP:** Designated Liaison Person for child protection concerns
- ✓ **Abuse types:** Physical (unexplained injuries), Emotional (withdrawn behaviour), Sexual (age-inappropriate behaviour), Neglect (hygiene/food/supervision)

3 REPORTING PROCEDURE

- ✓ **STEP 1** Staff informs DLP immediately
- ✓ **STEP 2** DLP completes Child Protection and Welfare Report Form
- ✓ **STEP 3** Report submitted to Tusla via Portal or directly
- ✓ **STEP 4** DLP follows up and records outcomes
- ✓ **EMERGENCY** Contact Gardaí directly if child at immediate risk

4 ROLES, TRAINING & RECORDS

- ✓ **All staff:** Report concerns immediately to DLP; complete Children First E-Learning + annual refresher
- ✓ **DLP:** Maintains records; liaises with Tusla and An Garda Síochána; ensures follow-up
- ✓ **Recruitment:** Garda vetting, reference checks, child protection induction
- ✓ **Records:** All concerns documented and stored securely for 7 years; accessible only to DLP and Manager
- ✓ **Confidentiality:** Need-to-know basis per GDPR and Children First guidelines

Tusla Policy Submission Pack

OPERATIONAL POLICIES & EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

5 COMPLAINTS (TUSLA FORMAT)

- ✓ Speak to staff, use anonymous complaint box, or contact Designated Complaints Officer
- ✓ Acknowledged within **3 working days**; full response within **10 working days**
- ✓ Escalation to Manager if unresolved; logged, tracked, and reviewed monthly

6 ANTI-BULLYING

- ✓ Covers physical/verbal abuse, online/social media threats, peer exclusion, intimidation
- ✓ Immediate intervention and recording; safety plan created; restorative sessions
- ✓ Parent/Tusla informed; reviewed after each incident

7 POSITIVE BEHAVIOUR SUPPORT

- ✓ Individualised BSPs; de-escalation training for all staff; consistent reward/consequence system
- ✓ Daily check-ins with child; **no physical or punitive sanctions permitted**

8 MISSING CHILD PROTOCOL

- ✓ **1** Notify Manager and search local area
- ✓ **2** Contact Gardaí and parent/Tusla within **15 minutes**
- ✓ **3** Record all actions and complete Incident Report
- ✓ **4** On return: debrief and safety planning with child; reviewed within 24 hours

9 STAFF CODE OF CONDUCT & DATA PROTECTION

- ✓ Child-centred professional relationships; respectful language; visible ID badges
- ✓ No personal contact info shared with children; report safeguarding concerns immediately
- ✓ Records stored securely (locked + encrypted); accessed by authorised staff only; retained 7 years
- ✓ Consent obtained for photography, data sharing, family contact; GDPR (2018) + Children First compliant

10 ANNUAL POLICY REVIEW LOG

Policy: _____ Date Reviewed: _____

Reviewed By: _____ Changes Made: ☐ Yes ☐ No

Manager Signature: _____ Date: _____

Tusla Inspector Signature (if present): _____